30-MINUTE CALL · PRINT AND MARK UP · SPEAK ONLY WHAT IS IN THE SAY BOXES

Apple CapEx — Systems Onboarding Data Integrity Program Manager

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Them. Capital Expenditure Systems Lead, Apple, Cupertino, hybrid. In role since June 2025; before that, CapEx Operations Program Manager (Feb 2022 – Jun 2025), including OPM on the first pilot in the line of business.

The seat. CapEx Systems Onboarding Data Integrity Program Manager. The team's stated purpose is change management: move people off "we have always done it this way," close the work without escalation, and make every input have a why.

Your position in minute one. You have moved live operations off side files onto a system of record, and you run data integrity as counted rows with an owner. You have not seen Apple's proprietary CapEx tool, and you will not pretend you have.

A. One-page cram sheet

CLOCK	WHAT YOU DO
0–2 Rapport	One human beat, then their language: system of record, pilot into a playbook, Procurement / Engineering / contract manufacturer. Do not pitch.
2–5 Tell me about yourself	75-second version in section B. Land four beats and stop: system of record, counted-row integrity, change without escalation, getting into the weeds. If they nod early, use the 45-second cut.
5–20 Their questions	Four answers cold, in this order of likelihood: **(1)** off spreadsheets onto a system of record — UDC dual inventory. **(5)** budget, schedule, and supplier in tension — RP to JDA. **(10)/(11)** a decision from someone who does not report to you, and a review that actually decides — architecture council, 44 rows. **(14)** a gate you missed — functional design planned July 26, signed August 14. Section H has the other eleven compact.
20–26 Product idea	Only if they invite "how would you improve this." Otherwise hold section G and stay on their thread. The idea is a question, not a critique.
26–30 Your questions + close	The three questions in section J, in that order. Close on one sentence: one instrument, one owner per field, no escalation of a row the owner can close.

Five numbers never to get wrong

- **7 → 68 customers = 9.7×**, targets landed two months early. `record` Never a promotional multiplier.
- **$0.66 → $0.03 per container, about 95%.** `record` The hand-carried start near a dollar comes up only if they ask.
- **Mocks 7.0% → 1.8% → 0.3% against 0.5%** published with Finance before the first mock. Eight months, on time, about 3% under a roughly $1.8M budget. `record` The dollar under is about $54K, your division of 3%.
- **836-row log, 714 closed = 85.4%.** Council pack: **44 requirement rows across 23 systems**; **seven system families, about two dozen named systems**. **Three reserve buckets**, not a longer list. `record / record-from-docs`
- **Functional design planned July 26, signed August 14.** Never say the gate chain held to the day. RF devices: say **hundreds**; device test before training; training moved 1.5 weeks; the go-live date held. `record`

Three phrases in their language

- **System of record.** "The side file stops being the decision once the forum will only read the system."
- **Data integrity, and the why behind every input.** "I can tell you who owns the field, what breaks if it is wrong, and which control catches it."
- **Change without escalation, playbook from the pilot.** "I pre-wire the owner. The pilot writes the playbook. I do not escalate a row the owner can close."

Three things never to say

1. Any promotional customer multiplier, and the resume's aggregate savings line. Use 9.7× and the program-level noun, one program at a time.
2. Inside knowledge of Apple's proprietary CapEx tool, or that your language-model triage agent was deployed at an employer. It was an independent build.
3. "The gate chain held to the day." The slide said July 26; the signature was August 14. Also never: nine reserve buckets; a device-failure ratio; a bill-of-material explosion; a six-site North America claim.

B. Tell me about yourself

Built for this interviewer. Four beats, in their order of care: system of record, counted integrity, change without escalation, weeds. Resume-faithful. No Apple tool, no aggregate savings.

75-SECOND VERSION — SAY THIS, THEN STOP

I run the operating system around a live supply-chain system, and I get into the data myself.

First, I have moved live operations off spreadsheets and side files onto a system of record. At Sephora a Utah building ran as two inventory books. We put it on one pool, with two selling identities and three reserve buckets, and we refused to convert historical transactions. Before that, two distribution centers moved from the legacy warehouse system to JDA, and the reconciliation tolerance was published before anyone could negotiate it.

Second, I run data integrity as a program with counted rows. That tolerance was half a percent, agreed with Finance before the first mock. The Utah program carried an 836-row issue log; 714 closed, 85.4 percent. On a European transportation program the report said 40 percent data quality; I pulled the history myself, the true figure was about 55 percent, and it reached about 99 percent within a quarter.

Third, I move teams who have always done it this way without escalating. I pre-wire every row with the person who owns the input. On a cadence change, the skeptic wrote the gate.

The weeds are the work. I have read application logs to find a missing trace id, and I count the rows myself before I call a go or a no-go.

45-SECOND VERSION — IF THEY CUT YOU OFF OR THE ROOM IS WARM

I move live operations off side files onto a system of record, and I treat data integrity as the program. At Sephora we took a Utah building from two inventory books to one pool with three reserve buckets, and we did not convert history. On a dual-DC warehouse cutover, Finance and I published a half-percent reconciliation tolerance before the first mock. I keep an issue log with an owner on every row — 836 rows, 85.4 percent closed — and I get teams to change by pre-wiring the owner, not by escalating. I count the rows myself before I call a gate.

- **If they ask “what did you personally do?”** “I wrote the scorecard, the gates, and the cadence, and I made the cutover call. Engineering built the code. DC Ops measured the 15 percent processing efficiency.”
- **Do not add** the aggregate savings line, a customer multiplier, or any sentence that starts “at Apple you do it by…”

C. Why Apple

60-SECOND VERSION — SPECIFIC TO THIS TEAM

You are moving CapEx off Excel-heavy, person-dependent tracking onto a system of record, so that later AI has a foundation it can trust. That sequence is the one I run. I will not automate a field I cannot reconcile. The only language-model tool I have built was an independent, eval-first exercise. It was never deployed at an employer.

The pattern on your profile — a first pilot in the line of business, then a playbook other programs can launch — is how I scale. I standardize the gate and the owner of each input, and I leave local whatever the floor truly varies.

What I want at Apple is the operations problem at this company’s manufacturing and supply-chain scale: capital equipment through contract manufacturers, where a placed-in-service date and the link from purchase order to asset are both a launch fact and a book fact. The job is change management with teams who have always done it this way, closed without escalation. That is work I have actually done, in warehouse systems and in data programs, not inside your tool.

I have not seen the proprietary system. If you want, I can walk the operating model I would bring, and I want you to correct it.

Grounding. The Excel-to-system migration, the centralized foundation for future AI, the pilot-to-playbook loop, and the Procurement / Engineering / contract-manufacturer alignment are the interviewer’s own public profile, as you have it. They are

not a claim about how the tool is built. The Apple line is scale and operations rigor in supply chain and manufacturing. No internal tool name, no invented metric, no “I already know your process.”

D. Solution design — how a CapEx system works at a company like Apple

My model, not inside knowledge. This section is my model of the domain, built from public knowledge of capital-equipment programs, the job description, and the interviewer’s public profile. It is not knowledge of Apple’s proprietary tool. In the call I say: “Here is how I understand it; correct me where I’m wrong.”

The interviewer’s profile describes a migration of multi-million-dollar programs off Excel-heavy, person-dependent tracking onto one system of record, with Procurement, Engineering, and contract manufacturers in the same launch, and with pilot lessons turned into a playbook. The picture below is how I would expect that operating model to be structured. Every dollar, station count, and date in section E is labelled illustrative.

IF THEY ASK YOU TO WALK IT — ABOUT 90 SECONDS, THEN HAND IT BACK

Here is how I understand a capital-equipment program on a system of record. Correct me where Apple does it differently.

It starts with a program need and a capacity model: units per hour, yield, shifts, lines. That becomes a list of tools and fixtures, then an appropriation with a cost center and a program code. Global Supply Management runs the quote and the purchase order. The supplier builds. Factory acceptance and site acceptance are different dates from placed-in-service. The contract manufacturer installs, tags, and says where the tool sits. Finance capitalizes: asset id, location, custodian, in-service date, depreciation start. Then ramp, then reuse or retrofit against a source asset, then disposition.

The seat I am interviewing for does not own those decisions. It makes sure every input has an owner, a reason, and a control that catches a bad value before the book closes. The join I would watch first is purchase order to asset. I would onboard one program as the pilot, write the playbook from the misses, and scale on the same gates.

If they turn “first ninety days” back on you

- **Days 1–20.** One live program. Count the side file against the system, field by field. The gap is a list, not a vibe.
- **Days 21–45.** An owner on each of the ten fields. A blank owner is the first exception, and it does not wait for a tool.
- **Days 46–70.** One reconciliation, purchase order to asset, denominator fixed, published before any cleanup.
- **Days 71–90.** One playbook page from that pilot: what we standardized, what stayed local. No new system.

That plan is my model of the seat. It is not a claim that Apple’s first ninety days are empty.

1. Lifecycle of capital equipment at a contract manufacturer

Program need → capacity model (units per hour, yield, shifts, lines) → equipment list, the bill of tools and fixtures → budget and approval (capital appropriation, cost center, program) → sourcing (GSM: RFQ, quote, purchase order) → supplier build → FAT then SAT → ship and install at the CM → asset tagging and capitalization (asset master, placed-in-service date, depreciation start, location, custodian) → ramp → sustaining, including retrofit and reuse across programs → disposition (transfer, idle, or scrap).

	1 Need	2 Buy	3 Accept	4 Books	5 Ramp	6 Reuse
TPM / AME	Capacity + tool list	spec	FAT / SAT	consulted	yield	retrofit decision
GSM	informed	RFQ, quote PO	supplier	PO open	—	transfer
CM site	shifts, lines	—	install	tag + location	runs line	physical
Finance / Systems / DI	program code	cost center on the PO	acceptance date	in-service + asset id	watch	source asset link

Dark cells are the lane that enters the input. Pale cells are consulted or informed. DI = Data Integrity PM.

The join that must not break: purchase order line → asset id, with one owner, before capitalization.

Model only. Correct me where Apple's lanes are different.

Swimlane. Six stages, four lanes. Read left to right. The books lane does not invent the physical fact; it records the fact the site and the GSM already own.

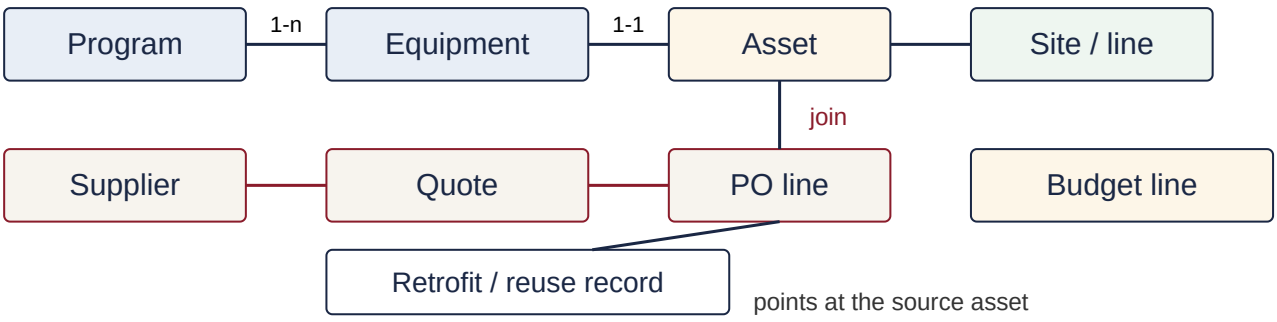
2. Who owns which input

One accountable owner per input. The Data Integrity PM does not take the business decision. The Data Integrity PM makes the missing or conflicting input visible, aged, and closable by that owner.

INPUT	GSM	TPM	AME	CM	FINANCE	SYS PM	DI PM
Capacity (UPH, yield, shifts, lines)	C	A	R	C	I	I	C
Tool and fixture list, internal ID	C	A	R	C	I	C	R
Appropriation, cost center, program	C	R	C	I	A	C	C
RFQ, quote, PO, currency	A	C	I	I	C	R	C
FAT / SAT and acceptance date	C	A	R	C	I	I	C
Install location, tag, custodian	I	C	C	R	C	C	A
Placed-in-service, depreciation start	I	C	I	C	A	R	R
Shared-tool program allocation	C	A	C	I	C	C	R
Reuse source asset	C	A	R	C	C	C	R
Exception queue for a broken join	R	C	C	R	C	C	A

R does the entry. A is the single accountable owner. C is consulted before the value is trusted. I is informed. On a shared tool, TPM is accountable for the split and Finance is accountable for the book.

3. Data model, and the why behind ten fields



Entity sketch. The purchase-order line is the join between what was bought and what is on the book. A reuse record points at an existing asset and must not create a second one.

ENTITY	FIELDS THAT HAVE TO BE TRUE
Program	Program code, owner, CM sites, appropriation id
Equipment / tool	Internal ID, supplier part number, serialized or quantity, station

ENTITY	FIELDS THAT HAVE TO BE TRUE
Supplier / quote / PO	Supplier id, quote currency, PO line, quantity, cost center
Asset	Asset id, tag, location, custodian, placed-in-service date, depreciation start
Site / line	CM, line, station
Budget line	Appropriation, program allocation if the tool is shared
Retrofit / reuse	Source asset id, receiving program, disposition of the old use

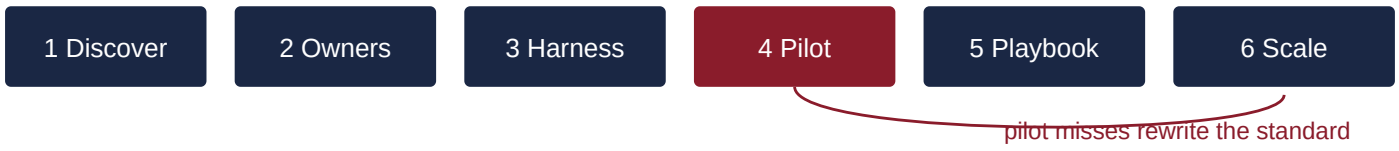
FIELD THAT GOES WRONG	WHY THE INPUT EXISTS	WHAT A BAD VALUE DOES
PO ↔ asset linkage	The buy and the book are one fact.	Orphan asset or an open PO that looks received.
Placed-in-service date	Depreciation starts on a real date.	Expense too early, or a live tool still “in transit” on the book.
Quantity vs serialized units	A station and a fixture are not the same grain.	40 ordered becomes 1 asset, or 40 tags for one line.
Site / location	The CM that holds the tool.	Wrong ramp, wrong custodian, failed physical count.
Cost center	Which org carries the asset.	FP&A cannot see the program.
Program allocation of a shared tool	One tool, more than one program.	Double count, or a hole in both programs.
Reuse source asset	Stops a second buy of a tool already on the book.	A new PO and a ghost asset.
FX / currency	The quote and the PO must be the same money.	Appropriation over or under, silent.
Acceptance date	FAT or SAT passed. It is not in-service.	Depreciation starts before the tool can run.
Supplier PN vs internal ID	The vendor’s number will not join the asset master.	Duplicates on every refresh from the CM or the supplier.

4. Where integrity breaks, and the control

WHERE IT ENTERS	TYPICAL BAD INPUT	CONTROL
Excel → system migration	Duplicate IDs, quantity pasted over serials, blank owner	Pre-load harness: schema, duplicate, referential checks, counted rows. No load on a red count.
Vendor quote and PO	Currency, supplier part number	Validation at entry. Currency required. A crosswalk from supplier part number to internal ID, owned by GSM + Data Integrity.
CM status update	Location, acceptance date typed as in-service	Owner per field. SAT pack required before acceptance date can close. CM cannot edit the depreciation date.
Manual status	Placed-in-service, program split, “someone knows”	PO ↔ invoice ↔ asset reconciliation. Exception queue with owner and age. Periodic physical-to-book count. Audit trail on every override.

Tolerances are published before the first load, the way I publish a reconciliation tolerance before the first mock. A gate that can be rewritten after the file arrives is not a gate. Person-dependent fields — the ones only one analyst can explain — are flagged on the scorecard until they have an owner in the system.

5. Onboarding a new program — six gates, then the playbook loop



GATE	ENTRY	EXIT BAR
1 Discover	Named sponsor and program code	Equipment list counted and signed by TPM and AME. Row count written down.
2 Owners	Signed list	An owner on each of the ten fields above. Blank owner blocks the gate.
3 Harness	The Excel or extract, not production	Schema, duplicate, serial, and referential checks green. Counted rows match the signed list.
4 Pilot load	Harness green, one line or one CM	PO ↔ asset reconciliation inside the tolerance published before the load. Every exception has an owner and an age.
5 Playbook	The pilot’s exception log	Standard work the next program can run without the pilot team in the room. What stayed local is written, not implied.
6 Scale	Playbook plus the same gates	First-time-right on the ten fields. The side file is not what the forum reads.

What I standardize from a pilot: the field owner, the tolerance, the exception grammar, and the reconciliation. What I leave local: the CM's station naming and the supplier's pack format, mapped through the crosswalk, not forced into one spreadsheet layout. That split is the same one I use when a pilot becomes a rollout.

E. Worked example — a new test-station line at a CM

> **Illustrative, end to end.** One made-up program: a new test-station line at a contract manufacturer for a product ramp. Every count and dollar in this section is ILLUSTRATIVE. None of it is an Apple program, an Apple site, or a figure from my record.

Shape of the example: ILLUSTRATIVE 40 stations at an illustrative unit cost of $75,000, so an illustrative equipment cost of $3,000,000. Two CM sites. Three suppliers. Twelve fixtures reused from a prior program, so those twelve must point at source assets and must not become twelve new purchase orders.

STEP	INPUT	WHO ENTERS	WHAT GOES WRONG	CONTROL AND EXCEPTION PATH
Need	Ramp needs a test line	TPM	Scope written as "tools" with no program code	No list starts without a program code. Data Integrity sends it back.
Capacity	UPH, yield, shifts, lines	AME, CM confirms shifts	CM shift pattern differs from the model	AME owns the number. A variance is a row, not a quiet edit.
Tool list	40 stations + fixtures; 12 marked reuse	AME drafts, TPM accountable, DI counts	12 reused fixtures pasted in as new buys	Reuse flag required. Source asset id required or the row is red.
Budget	Appropriation and cost center	Finance accountable, TPM requests	Shared metrology tool allocated 100% to this program	Shared-tool rule: allocation must sum to 100% across programs.
Source	3 suppliers, quotes, POs	GSM	One quote in a different currency	Currency required. Mismatch parks the line before the PO is cut.
Build / FAT	Supplier build, FAT date	Supplier via GSM; AME witnesses	FAT date later typed as in-service	Acceptance date and in-service date are different fields. CM cannot edit the second.
Ship / install	Site, line, station	CM	A station arrives at site 2 with site 1 on the PO	Location owner is the CM. Mismatch opens an exception; the asset is not capitalized.
Tag / capitalize	Asset id, tag, in-service, custodian	Finance accountable; Systems PM posts; DI reconciles	See the exception below	Counted reconciliation before the book closes.
Ramp	Station actually running	CM and AME	Book says in service; line is not yielding	In-service requires SAT plus CM confirmation, not FAT alone.
Reuse / disposition	12 source assets	TPM accountable, Finance updates the book	Old asset still "in use" on the prior program	Reuse record closes the old use or the new row stays open.

One reconciliation, all the way through

ILLUSTRATIVE At capitalization week the counted reconciliation is: 40 purchase-order lines in scope, 38 assets tagged, 2 lines with no asset. The two are not "missing." The carrier event says they are in transit to site 2, and the CM has not received them.

- **Log.** Two exception rows, same day, on the program queue. Type: PO without asset. Grain: PO line. Count written on the row: 40 expected, 38 tagged, 2 open.
- **Owner.** Data Integrity PM is accountable for the queue. GSM owns the PO fact. The CM owns the receipt. Finance does not capitalize either line.
- **Age.** The clock starts at the promised receipt date. I would set the age bar with Finance during the pilot. I am not assuming Apple's number.
- **Close.** A row closes only when an asset id, a tag, a location, and a placed-in-service date post, or when GSM confirms the line is still a legitimate in-transit with a carrier event newer than the age bar. "We think it arrived" does not close it.
- **What I refuse to do.** I do not let the 38 post and drop the 2 off the scorecard so the program looks at 100%. The denominator stays 40 until the two rows close or the scope is formally cut.

That is the same mechanism as a mock reconciliation: publish the tolerance and the denominator before the file arrives, classify the miss, name the owner, and do not change the denominator to go green.

F. Resume → this role

Every experience bullet on the Apple-tailored resume, in the inventory already mapped in the Apple delta add-on. The raw resume text file was not on disk for this build; that add-on states the table is complete. The summary line is a guardrail, not a story.

RESUME BULLET	JD LINE IT PROVES	STORY AND NUMBER	20-SECOND VERSION
S/4HANA ↔ ISM; one definition of available; legacy inventory system retired; zero incidents.	Accuracy of the input. One meaning the whole chain uses.	S1 / E1. Zero customer-facing incidents. **record**	I owned the policy and the integration governance. ERP engineers owned configuration. A unit was not available until someone had dispositioned it.
Portfolio system: RAID, 836-item log, 343-task runbook, numeric rollback, 60+ stakeholders.	Track, prioritize, and close many tasks. Protocols.	836 rows, 714 closed = 85.4%. 343 tasks, about 815 task-hours. 60+ stakeholders. **record**	One log for the umbrella program, not a side status. Owner, age, and a close. Rollback triggers were numeric and never fired.
UDC omni launch on Blue Yonder plus robotics; staged gates; efficiency up.	Manufacturing and supply-chain program work. Milestones. Learn the system.	+15% processing efficiency, DC Ops' measure. Two go-lives, zero customer-facing incidents. **record**	I had not configured that WMS. I ran gates. DC Ops measured the 15 percent. I do not claim the code.
Re-sequenced an 18-month roadmap; 66% less effort; value in six months.	Influence. Analytical. Change a plan people already believed.	18 months to value in 6. 66% less effort. About $5M of avoided cost, once. **record**	I brought the cost-to-serve comparison to the person who owned the roadmap. Avoided cost, not an annual reduction.
Scaled 4PL visibility from 7 customers; cost-to-serve; a separate accuracy program.	Pilot, then a wider launch. Data integrity. Learn software fast.	7 → 68 = 9.7×, two months early. $0.66 → $0.03 per container, about 95%. Accuracy 60% → 90% is the other story. **record**	Six graduation criteria, not a date. I keep the customer ramp and the accuracy pipeline as two stories.
Dual-DC legacy ERP to JDA in eight months; three mocks; pipeline behind the date.	Budget, schedule, and supplier in one program. High accuracy.	Mocks 7.0% → 1.8% → 0.3% vs 0.5% before mock one. On time. About 3% under roughly $1.8M. $20M pipeline of four programs. **record**	The pipeline is value unblocked, not savings I bank. The pass line was Finance's as well as mine.
VP-sponsored move of a 20-person group onto a four-week cadence; defects down.	Change management without escalation. People skills.	20 people. Six-week to four-week cadence in six weeks. Critical defects −50%. **record**	Nobody reported to me. The skeptic in QA wrote the gate and defended it.
SAP supply and demand view; daily reconciliation; forecast accuracy; safety stock.	Analytical, high accuracy, adherence to a protocol. Excel-grade hygiene on a system.	Forecast accuracy 70% → 85%. About $2M safety stock released. Planner collaboration up 50%. **record**	I say collaboration up, not effort down. The release rule was the one Planning and Finance signed.
About 1,000 supplier and carrier routes; valid ASN at or above 95%; completeness up.	Vendor onboarding. Data integrity as the toll to go live.	A thousand-lane program across 25 European locations. Completeness 60% → 95%. **record** Delivered-count split is not settled.	Phased by value. If asked what went live first, the 597 figure is my earlier anchor, not the settled count.
MetricStream: dual-hat PM and solution lead. SOWs, estimates, budgets, onshore and offshore, through UAT, cutover, hypercare.	Vendor relationships. Timelines. Do what the delivery needs.	No safe client, headcount, or dollar in the source set.	I owned the SOW and the delivery. I will not invent a client or a value.
Manhattan OMS across 3 DCs and 100 stores; stockouts, fill, protected sales.	Get into the weeds. Cover the live operation. Supply chain.	99% fill vs a 95% bar. Stockouts −20%. About $6M on the line when paged; about $8M of that day's sales protected. **record**	Those are different nouns. On the line is not the same figure as protected.
Summary line only: an aggregate savings claim.	Do not use it to prove anything.	No reconciled ledger. Do not say the aggregate.	I will use each program's number with its noun rather than blend savings, avoided cost, released inventory, and protected revenue.

> **What I have not done.** I have not used Apple's proprietary CapEx tool, and I have not run a factory capital-equipment launch. Tableau and Power BI do not appear in the mapped experience bullets. **Safe sentence:** "I build the scorecard in the tool the team already reads. I am not a dashboard stylist. I can interrogate the data underneath it, including in SQL, which I have done when a reported quality number did not match the rows. If this team's view is Tableau, I will learn the view. The grain, the owner,

and the tolerance are the part I already run.” Excel is a must-have on the JD and is how the side files I replace are actually kept; I do not need to pretend it is the system of record.

G. Product improvement idea — ask it, do not pitch it

THE QUESTION, ABOUT 45 SECONDS, ONLY IF INVITED

The profile says the system of record is the foundation for later AI. I would not put a model on a field I cannot reconcile, because a wrong join compounds. The thing I would want in the first pilot is a weekly data-integrity scorecard, per program and per input owner: completeness and validity on the fields that actually move the book, exception aging, purchase-order to asset reconciliation with the denominator held still, and a flag on any field that only one person can explain. Onboarding playbooks would be measured on a first-time-right rate, not on a go-live date. Does that grain already exist, and is the gap the owner — or is the gap the view?

Three metrics, defined before the first file arrives.

- **Reconciliation.** Tagged assets divided by purchase-order lines in scope. In-transit stays in the denominator until the row closes or scope is cut.
- **First-time-right.** Share of the ten high-risk fields that pass validation on first load, by program and by owner.
- **Exception aging.** Share of open exceptions older than the age bar Finance and the Data Integrity PM set in the pilot. I will not invent that bar in the room.

MVP in six weeks, one pilot program. Weeks 1–2: field dictionary and a named owner for each of the ten fields. Weeks 3–4: one reconciliation extract, PO to invoice to asset, and an exception queue with owner and age. Weeks 5–6: one weekly view the forum actually reads, even if the refresh is a query. A polished visual can wait.

What I would not build first. An anomaly model, a contract-manufacturer portal, a backfill of every historical program, or a leaderboard. The second, smaller idea is the pre-migration harness: schema, duplicate and serial checks, referential checks, and a counted-rows go or no-go before any Excel file touches the system. That harness is the entry bar to the scorecard, not a second product.

One risk. If the view shames owners, they go back to the side file. I would design it as that owner’s queue, reviewed in their forum, with Data Integrity accountable for the queue and the business owner accountable for the value.

Still my model. I am describing a scorecard I would propose. I am not describing a gap I have seen inside Apple. The AI line is the interviewer’s own public profile: a centralized data foundation for future AI applications. My independent triage agent — eval set first, a citation on every proposal, unit cost from $25 to $0.40 — is the proof I know how to refuse automation. It was not deployed at an employer.

H. Likely questions — STAR

Cold answers are 1, 5, and 10 with 11. The other eleven are the 45-second cut. Every answer is first person. A number carries its basis. One failure line. One data-integrity line: what was wrong, who owned it, what control fixed it.

1. A time you took a process off spreadsheets onto a system of record — what broke in month one, what you refused to migrate

S At Sephora the Utah building ran as two systemic warehouses, Dotcom and Retail, with transfers and side tracking between the books. record

T Put one physical unit on one system of record, with no customer-facing miss, and without migrating history I could not defend.

A Discovery, then an architecture council, one row per impacted system, pre-wired with its owner. The model we signed was one pool, two selling identities, and three reserve buckets, with no conversion of historical transactions. Purchasing and inbound went first; the combined cutover came after. In the interim, every report had to name which book it read.

R Two go-lives, zero customer-facing incidents. Processing efficiency +15%, DC Ops' own measurement. record The issue log for that umbrella program is 836 rows.

Failure. Month one of the interim broke for the analyst, not the shopper: two truths, hand reconciliation. I had left that reporting experience off the first deck. What I refused to migrate was history.

Data integrity. The bad input was "which book is this unit on." The council owned the definition. The control was one location, three named buckets, and a written refusal to convert history.

2. How you got people to stop keeping a side file

S A weekly review was four systems plus the extract someone trusted, because the systems disagreed. record

T Make the side file stop being the decision, without banning it by mandate.

A One scorecard, one grain, one date. The forum would not read a number that did not match it. Cutover waited for a parallel run within 1%. record

R System accuracy moved from 60% to 90%. record The extract died because the meeting stopped accepting it.

Failure. Usage is not adoption. Adoption is the old path losing its seat in the decision.

Data integrity. The bad input was a metric with no grain. I owned the instrument. The control was one scorecard the forum would actually use.

3. A pilot you ran before a wider rollout — what you standardized, what you left local

S Shipment Visibility started as hand-carried pilots. Seven customers. record

T Scale only what the pilot had proved.

A I standardized six graduation criteria and a calibration bar on the customer's own containers. I left carrier-specific mapping local. I do not name the first two customers.

R 7 → 68 customers, 9.7×, and 170 users, two months early. record A public shipment target stayed a target.

Failure. I will not say every public target landed. The customer count and the user count did.

Data integrity. The bad input would have been our demo file standing in for theirs. I owned the entry bar. The control was no graduation without the customer's own data.

4. When the system and the floor disagreed, which did you change

S Locus robots, Salt Lake City DC, week two: 94% pick-accurate against a 98% gate published before the bots took volume. record

T Choose the floor or the gate. Not both, quietly.

A I did not lower the gate. I throttled about 30% of volume onto manual carts while zone logic was fixed.

R Full automation in week three. Combined go-live held. Zero customer-facing incidents. record

Failure. Physical readiness was not its own row, so the earlier slip arrived as a vendor message.

Data integrity. The input was pick-accurate throughput. The program owned the gate; the floor lived the consequence. The control was the dial, with the denominator unchanged.

5. A multi-team launch where budget, schedule, and supplier were all in tension

S Two distribution centers, legacy warehouse system to JDA, eight months, a $20M pipeline of four programs waiting on the date. I had never run that migration. Budget roughly $1.8M. record

T One recommendation that could hold the date, the budget, and the supplier quality at the same time.

A Five gated phases. Finance and I published a 0.5% reconciliation tolerance before the first mock. Mock one came back at 7.0%, mock two at 1.8%, mock three at 0.3%. I took the 7.0% upstairs with my name on it. The go-live note cited the scorecard.

R On time. About 3% under, roughly $54K by my division of that 3%. Hypercare cleared its exit — under two blocker tickets a day — in week three of four. The pipeline started the month after. That is unblocked pipeline, not banked savings. record

Failure. I had scored device conversion by effort. Hundreds of devices; training moved 1.5 weeks; the date held because device test came before we called training done.

Data integrity. The bad inputs were reconciliation classes: unit of measure, location names, order-status codes. Engineering owned the extract. Finance and I owned the tolerance. The control was a mock scorecard whose denominator we did not rewrite.

6. Engineering wanted a capability finance would not fund

S The release people wanted was “forecast improved, so release the safety stock.” Finance would not fund a release on one error. record

T Land a real release the book could defend.

A Planning and Finance signed a both-errors-improved rule. I did not ask engineering to build the looser one.

R Forecast accuracy 70% → 85% on the scoped set. About $2M of safety stock released. Planner collaboration up 50%. record

Failure. The wrong noun would have been “planner effort down.” Collaboration went up.

Data integrity. The bad input was a single accuracy number standing in for two errors. Finance owned the release rule. The control was both errors improved before a dollar moved.

7. Where you saved real money by reusing an asset or avoiding a buy

S I do not have a capital-equipment reuse dollar in my record. I will not borrow a retrofit figure I did not earn.

T Answer with a real reuse, then the avoided-cost noun if they want a dollar.

A On the Canada bulk-ship design we reused the existing cross-dock path and two mailbox locations. The system change was six items, five of them small. record-from-docs That outcome is the plan at discovery exit. I will not quote a post-launch saving.

R The dollar I will say, once, is different: about $5M of avoided cost on the forwarding-app sequence, value in six months instead of eighteen. record Avoided cost, not a machine reused.

Failure. If I skip the noun, a listener adds it to something else. I say the noun first.

Data integrity. The bad input would have been a new location created when one already posted. Design owned that choice. The control was “point at the path that exists.”

8. A supplier or vendor who slipped

S Locus needed three more weeks of retail testing. My council timeline said retail end-to-end on January 15. record

T Keep the slip visible. Do not hide it in a shorter test.

A Steering got the choice the week it surfaced: compress acceptance testing, or move the date. We moved it. The network work sat under a written SOW, with photo evidence before anything powered on.

R Retail end-to-end completed at the end of January. The combined go-live did not move. Zero customer-facing incidents. record

Failure. That readiness row should have existed when the wiring SOW was signed, not a month later.

Data integrity. The bad input was a date that belonged to the vendor's calendar and sat on my slide as if it were mine. I owned it once it was on the slide. The control was a revision in the open.

9. Three teams wanted three outcomes

S Retail wanted store fill, Dotcom wanted a sellable unit, Finance wanted one book. Same building. None of them reported to me.

T One design all three would sign.

A One pool, two selling identities, three reserve buckets. History conversion, a reserve-math rewrite, and a reporting rebuild were written down as not built.

R Two go-lives, zero customer-facing incidents. `record` 44 requirement rows were the manifest.

Failure. Finance's analyst still lived with two books for four months. That was my miss.

Data integrity. Three teams were about to write three versions of on-hand. The control was one signed definition and an owner per bucket.

10. A decision from someone who did not report to you, and who was not in the meeting

S Architecture council, sixty-plus stakeholders. Digital, finance, and merchandising did not report to me, and not every owner was going to be in the room. `record`

T Get the decision from the owner of the row before the meeting, or do not pretend the meeting made it.

A I pre-wired every row with its owner. The room was asked only for what was still open: the architecture, the location and reserve model, the staged timeline, and the fence. The pack was 44 requirement rows across 23 systems, seven families, about two dozen named systems. `record-from-docs`

R The council signed the architecture on July 31. The estimates on the rows were the owners' estimates.

Failure. I printed a functional-design date the owners had not finished. Pre-wire the date the same way you pre-wire the row.

Data integrity. Each row was an input. A row with no named owner did not enter the pack. That was the control.

11. How you run a review so it makes a decision

S The same council would have failed if the agenda had been status.

T Leave with a decision, an owner, and a date — or an explicit no.

A A row reaches the room only after its owner has seen it. I ask for a decision or a fence. I read the red item myself. There is no second deck.

R The architecture, the model, the timeline, and the out-of-scope fence were signed. The go-lives later held. `record`

Failure. A review that cannot say no is a status meeting. The date on that slide was me decorating a gate.

Data integrity. The artifact is the row: field, owner, estimate. If the review cannot name those, it is not ready to decide.

12. A playbook from a messy pilot

S The first visibility customers were hand-carried. The mess was calibration, connectivity, and a pull to customize each one.

T Write the standard the next wave could run without me in the room.

A Six graduation criteria became the playbook. Carrier mapping stayed local. A later gate — 500 containers in 20 minutes at 99.6% connectivity before customer testing — is the same rule. `record-from-docs`

R 7 → 68, two months early. `record`

Failure. An earlier test passed for five users across ten scenarios and crashed two days before sign-off, because I had tested my shape. The playbook now requires the customer's shape.

Data integrity. The input I refused to skip was the customer's own data. I owned the bar. No graduation without it.

13. Someone you mentored

S I have no direct-report mentoring story in the record, and I will not invent a name. The closest is a QA lead on a 20-person cadence change who did not report to me.

T Leave the gate in their hands.

A They authored the ceremony. I published whether work actually reached QA and demo. The QA lead wrote the definition of done and defended it. Neighboring teams copied it from the user guide.

R Six-week cadence to four-week, in six weeks. Critical defects −50%. `record`

Failure. If “mentor” means a person on my org chart, I say I have not had that seat. What I have done is make a skeptic the owner.

Data integrity. I was the person-dependent field. The control was the gate, owned in writing by QA.

14. A program gate you missed

S On July 31 I presented a council timeline that said functional-design sign-off on July 26. It was not signed. Build on the upstream rows had been open since June 9. `record-from-docs` for the slide, `record` for the signature.

T Close the spec without smuggling scope, and without moving the go-lives.

A I named the slip the week it was clear. Rows whose owners had already started stayed fenced. The downstream rows got the re-read they asked for. We signed on August 14. I do not say the chain held to the day.

R About three weeks late on the spec. Both go-lives held. Zero customer-facing incidents. `record` What changed: I count the signers by name before a date is printed, and discovery results close with the functional design as one gate.

Failure. An optimistic date costs more trust than the slip. If they want the other miss: hundreds of RF devices, training plus 1.5 weeks, go-live date held, because I had scored risk by effort instead of by impact.

Data integrity. The bad input was a date with no signer list. I owned it. The control is a named list before the date exists.

15. An AI use case on the CapEx system — which data you would refuse to automate until it is trustworthy

S The profile treats the system of record as the foundation for later AI. I agree with the sequence, and I have not seen the tool. `model`

T Name the fields I would not automate.

A I would refuse placed-in-service date, the purchase-order to asset join, and the reuse-source link until reconciliation sits inside a published tolerance and every exception has an owner. My only language-model build was independent: eval set first, a citation on every proposal, unit cost from $25 to $0.40. `record` It was not deployed at an employer.

R The result I want credit for is the refusal. A narrative draft can be assisted. A book field cannot be guessed.

Failure. I once scoped a pipeline for correctness and discovered the access review mid-build. Same lesson: do not automate a field whose lineage you have not named.

Data integrity. Those three fields compound into depreciation and a second buy. A person owns them until the scorecard is green. That is the control.

I. Behavioral specifics the job description implies

Covered someone else’s work so the team succeeded

S At an Austria transportation site the report said data quality was 40%, and the room blamed carriers. `record`

T Get a number the team could act on, even though the census was not “my job.”

A I pulled three years of history in SQL myself. True quality was about 55%, not 40%. The defect was our measurement.

R About 99% within a quarter. Manual reconciliation from 8–10 hours a week to 1–2. Austria about $500K a year on a Finance-signed, executed-only method; about $8M across 25 European sites on that same method. `record`

Failure. I carried the census alone longer than I should have. The design of the measure belonged in the room earlier.

Data integrity. The reported 40% was a single-field proxy. I owned the recount. The control was a defect census before anyone blamed a carrier.

Learned a new software fast

S I had never run a WMS migration, and the dual-DC move to JDA did not come with a guidebook. `record`

T Learn the system well enough to set gates, not well enough to pretend I configured it.

A I learned it in the mocks, class by class, and on a later visibility program I learned the event path through six systems well enough to find a missing trace id. Bugs went from hours to locate to traceable per system. `record-from-docs` I will not quote a time-cut percentage.

R The JDA cutover went on time against a tolerance I could explain. The trace id is what made monitoring possible.

Failure. I learned the trace-id hole during testing, not during design. Next time the identifier is a design row.

Data integrity. The missing input was a trace id. Engineering owned the pipe. I owned the test that proved the hole. The control is an identifier before the first customer test.

Closed an issue without escalation

S QA and engineering were headed for a standoff on a cadence a VP wanted changed. I had no authority to settle it by rank.

T Close it in the room.

A The skeptic authored the gate. I brought evidence of whether work reached QA, not an escalation email.

R Four-week cadence in six weeks, on a 20-person group. Critical defects −50%. `record`

Failure. Early on I was tempted to ask the VP to rule. The gate would have been mine, and it would have died when I left.

Data integrity. The contested input was “is this story done.” QA owned it after the change. The control was their written definition of done.

Kept many tasks tracked and closed

S The umbrella program’s log is 836 rows over the life of the Utah conversion, not a private list. `record`

T Prioritize and close, in the open.

A One row, one owner, an age, a severity. The grammar the log itself used: 331 go-live, 77 fast-follow, 36 enhancement. Just over half the book was Blocker or Critical.

R 714 of 836 closed, 85.4%. `record` The cutover beside it was 343 tasks, about 815 task-hours.

Failure. A log without an owner is a diary. I have let a row sit when the owner was a team name. Team names do not close rows.

Data integrity. The row is the input. A named person owns it. The control is the close rate on a denominator we do not shrink.

Adhered to a protocol when it was slower

S A pipeline I had scoped carried customer content. I had planned correctness and not the access review. `record`

T Keep the weekly review alive without bypassing the review.

A I did not ask for an exception. The manual path stayed up. Cutover still waited for parity within 1%.

R The access review cost two weeks. The Monday review never missed. `record`

Failure. The protocol was slower because I discovered it. It now sits on the kickoff checklist, which is cheaper than discovering it mid-build.

Data integrity. The bad input was “this extract is fine to join.” Security owned access. I owned the scope that forgot them. The control is access lead time planned at the start, and no cutover inside the parity bar.

J. Questions to ask

Ask these three, in this order, in the last four minutes. Then stop. The backup replaces (2) if they have already told you where the side file still wins.

1 — SAY THIS

On the pilot that became the playbook, which lesson did teams actually follow, and which one did you have to keep enforcing?

2 — SAY THIS

Where does the CapEx system still lose to a side spreadsheet, and what would you want a program manager to do about that in the first ninety days?

3 — SAY THIS

When Engineering and Finance disagree on a launch, who makes the call today, and what evidence do they need in the room?

BACKUP — ONLY IF (2) IS ALREADY ANSWERED

What does "data integrity" mean on this team in numbers — which field, which rate, measured where?

Close, one breath. "I baseline the number, I put one instrument in the room, and I do not escalate a row the owner can close. I would like the seat that makes that true for onboarding."

Listen for: which field they name, who they say owns it, and whether the pilot lesson is a document or a gate that has actually stopped a program. Write their words down. Do not improve them.

K. Verify list, safe sentences, source trace

Say the safe sentence if you cannot confirm. Do not upgrade a label in the room.

#	FACT	SAFE SENTENCE
V1	Canada bulk-ship results after discovery exit are not in the sources.	"That was the plan at discovery exit. I will not quote a post-launch workload or brand count."
V2	How many of the thousand lanes actually went live. 597 is an earlier anchor, not the settled count.	"A thousand-lane program across 25 European locations. I phased by value."
V3	Austria quality timing: sources disagree on two months versus about three.	"About 99 percent within a quarter."
V4	Device fleet size. The two tellings disagree.	"Hundreds of RF devices. Training moved a week and a half. The go-live date held."
V5	Names of the first visibility customers disagree across documents.	"The first two hand-carried customers."
V6	MetricStream: responsibilities are on the resume. No client, headcount, or outcome is.	"I owned SOWs, estimates, budgets, and delivery through hypercare. I will not attach a client or a dollar."
V7	The resume summary adds unlike savings, avoidance, released inventory, and protected revenue.	"I will use each program's number with its noun. I will not quote the rolled-up total."
V8	Tableau and Power BI are not in the mapped experience bullets. The resume text file was not on disk; the bullet inventory is the Apple delta add-on, which states it is complete. SQL is a practice in the stories, not a skill line I could re-read off the resume file.	"I am not a dashboard stylist. I can interrogate the rows, including in SQL. If the view is Tableau, I will learn the view."
V9	No direct report and no named mentee in the sources.	"I have not had that seat. The person I grew into an owner was the QA lead who wrote the gate."
V10	No capital-equipment reuse dollar in the record.	"I don't have that dollar. The reuse I can show is a path we did not rebuild. The avoided-cost figure is a different noun."
V11	Why the functional design slipped is reconstructed. The dates are sourced: slide said July 26, signed August 14.	"The slide said July 26. We signed August 14. I would rather own the date than the excuse."

#	FACT	SAFE SENTENCE
V12	The language-model triage agent was an independent build.	“I built it independently. It was not deployed at an employer.”
V13	Anything about Apple’s CapEx tool, age bars, or who signs a launch.	“Here is how I understand it. Correct me where I’m wrong.”
V14	Trace-id time saved. A half-reduction appears only as your own note.	“Bugs went from hours to locate to traceable per system. I will not quote a percentage.”
V15	About $54K under budget is 3% of roughly $1.8M, your division.	“About 3 percent under a roughly $1.8 million budget. The dollar under is my division, not a separate record.”

Source trace — numbers in sections B, F, and H

NUMBER	WHERE	STORY	SOURCE FILE	MATCH
Three reserve buckets; no historical conversion	B, H1, H9	UDC dual inventory	udc-canada-story-pack (council deck p.4)	Y
0.5% before mock one; 7.0% → 1.8% → 0.3%	B, F, H5	RP → JDA, D2	goforth-pgm-stories P2; apple-delta D2	Y
836 rows; 714 closed = 85.4%	B, F, H1, I	UDC issues log	numbers-reconciliation S2.03; apple-delta	Y
Reported 40%; true about 55%; about 99% within a quarter	B, I	S10 Austria	cabreros-stories-b S10; numbers-reconciliation S10	Y on the levels; months = within a quarter
Zero customer-facing incidents; +15% DC Ops	F, H1, H4	UDC C1	apple-delta resume map; udc pack	Y
343 tasks; about 815 task-hours; 60+ stakeholders	F, I	UDC cutover / council	apple-delta; numbers-reconciliation S2.12 (48,885 min)	Y, hours rounded
18 months → value in 6; 66%; about $5M avoided cost	F, H7	S12 / B2	apple-delta numbers check	Y, avoided-cost noun
7 → 68 = 9.7×; two months early; 170 users	F, H3, H12	S11 / A1	apple-delta; numbers-reconciliation S11	Y, 9.7× is 68/7
$0.66 → $0.03 per container, about 95%	F	S11 / A1	apple-delta; numbers-reconciliation S11	Y, rounded from 95.45%
System accuracy 60% → 90%; parity within 1%	F, H2, I	S16 / A3 and G3	apple-delta A3 / G3	Y
Eight months; about 3% under roughly $1.8M; $20M pipeline of four programs	F, H5	S18 / D1	goforth-pgm-stories P2; apple-delta	Y
About $54K under	H5	3% of roughly $1.8M	goforth-pgm-stories P2	Your division, say so
Under two blocker tickets a day, week three of four	H5	S18 hypercare	goforth-pgm-stories P2	Y
20 people; six-week → four-week in six weeks; critical defects −50%	F, H13, I	S15 / D3	apple-delta; cabreros-stories-b S15	Y, defect result via resume
Forecast 70% → 85%; about $2M safety stock; collaboration up 50%	F, H6	S6 / F3	apple-delta numbers check	Y
Thousand-lane program; 25 European locations; completeness 60% → 95%	F	S9 / F1	apple-delta; numbers-reconciliation S9	Y on the program; delivered split unresolved
3 DCs + 100 stores; 99% vs 95%; stockouts −20%; about $6M on the line; about $8M protected	F	S13 / M1	apple-delta M1	Y, nouns kept apart
94% vs 98% gate; about 30% throttled; full automation week three	H4	Locus Salt Lake City	goforth-pgm-stories P3; udc pack	Y
Six changes, five small; cross-dock path reused	H7	Canada discovery	udc-canada-story-pack B2	Y as the plan at discovery exit
Retail E2E planned Jan 15, completed end of January; combined go-live held	H8, H14	Locus slip / council timeline	udc pack B5, B6	Y
44 rows / 23 systems; seven families; about two dozen named systems	H9, H10	Council pack pp.9, 13–14	udc-canada-story-pack conflict row 6	Y, source doc over “about a dozen” alone
FSD planned Jul 26; signed Aug 14; council Jul 31	H10, H14	B5	udc pack B5; apple-delta does not say the chain held	Y

NUMBER	WHERE	STORY	SOURCE FILE	MATCH
Hundreds of devices; training +1.5 weeks; date held	H5, H14	G2	apple-delta G2; numbers-reconciliation S18.09	Y after conflict resolution
500 containers / 20 min / 99.6%; 5 users × 10 scenarios; crash 2 days before sign-off	H12	A5 and G1	apple-delta A02	Y
$25 → $0.40; citations on every proposal	H15, G	I1 independent agent	apple-delta A01	Y, not an employer deployment
8–10 hours/week → 1–2; about $500K Austria; about $8M across 25 European sites	I	S10	cabreros-stories-b S10	Y, executed-only method
331 go-live / 77 fast-follow / 36 enhancement; just over half Blocker or Critical	I	UDC log categories	numbers-reconciliation S2.04, S2.05	Y, 441/836 rounded in speech
Access review cost two weeks	I	G3	apple-delta G3	Y
Four months with two systems of record	H1, H9	UDC interim	apple-delta JΔ5; udc pack	Y
Illustrative 40 stations, $75,000, $3,000,000, 2 sites, 3 suppliers, 12 fixtures, 40 / 38 / 2	E only	Worked example	This packet	ILLUSTRATIVE, not a source

Files behind the short names: amazon/panel/amazon-nacf-apple-delta-addon-star-kimi-k3.html; amazon/numbers-reconciliation.md; amazon/panel/amazon-nacf-udc-canada-story-pack-star-kimi-k3.html; amazon/panel/amazon-nacf-panel-3-goforth-pgm-stories-star-kimi-k3.html; amazon/panel/amazon-nacf-panel-4-cabreros-stories-b-star-kimi-k3.html. Apple workbook v11 and the Apple-tailored resume were not on disk as text; every resume bullet above is the bullet the delta add-on says it mapped, and every number is one that add-on or the reconciliation already checked. No new client, headcount, or outcome was added.